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Lead Feature

Keeping It Cool

PC cabinets are just boxes that hold our components, and keeping it cool is only a matter of adding fans, right? Wrong!

**Robert Sovereign-Smith and
Nimish Chandiramani**

It all started when a colleague wanted to show off his latest geek-venture. Working for Digit, it's tradition to show off the latest gizmos and gadgets. This particular colleague hadn't bought anything new—he'd just added a lot of fans to his cabinet, and was now claiming to have the coolest cabinet in town. We counted

12 fans in all—overkill for sure! However, what he didn't know was that his 12 fans were not helping much...

All About Airflow

Keeping a cabinet cool isn't as simple as just adding an obscene number of fans on the top, back, front and side. What you need to focus on, when improving cooling is how the air flows, and how you can make sure that cool air hits the components that get hot. Now some case-modders have done crazy things, like integrating table fans into their cabinets, so powerful that you see IDE cables flapping in the breeze, or there are those that use liquid cooling... however, most of us are tech-crazy, not stark raving mad! Our colleague had some intake fans right next to exhausts, which was defeating his purpose.

Since we were planning on starting a series of DIY articles, we figured we might as well start with cabinet cooling and airflow.

Thinking about this article, the very first problem that cropped up was, how do we show airflow? Now we could go out and get expensive smoke machines to fill the cabinet with

